

MEMBERSHIP REPORT

¶ 230-242, 2008 Book of Discipline, The United Methodist Church

A membership audit is required by the *Discipline* to be done annually. The pastor is responsible for ensuring that all membership records are accurate and up to date (*Discipline*, ¶340.2c (2f)).

The 2004 General Conference redefined membership in the United Methodist Church. It abolished the old classifications – Full Members and Preparatory Members – and replaced them with new ones: **Professing Members** and **Baptized Members**.

New Membership Definitions:

- **Baptized member:** A baptized member is a person who has received the sacrament of baptism in a United Methodist Church or has received Christian baptism in another denomination and later transferred to a United Methodist Church.
- **Professing member:** A professing member is a baptized person who has taken vows declaring the Christian faith.

The change in terminology signals a major shift in understanding what it means to be a United Methodist. It also changes membership record-keeping.

The new *2009-2012 United Methodist Membership Records Manual with CD-ROM* from Cokesbury (Cokesbury.com, \$12), developed by the General Council on Finance and Administration, may be helpful in collecting the data. Paragraph 230 of *The Book of Discipline 2008* details the records each church is required to keep. Here are highlights:

Each local church must maintain an accurate membership record for each baptized or professing member, including:

- o Name, address, date and place of birth, date of baptism, pastor and sponsors, and, as appropriate;
- o Date of confirmation/profession of faith, pastor and sponsors;
- o Date received by transfer, sending church and receiving pastor;
- o Date transferred to another church, name and address of receiving church;
- o Date of removal or withdrawal from membership and reason;
- o Date of restoration of professing membership and pastor;
- o Date of death, date and place of memorial service, place of burial and officiating pastor.

Each church is also to maintain a Constituency Roll with the names and addresses of nonmembers for whom it has pastoral responsibility. This includes children.

All professing and baptized members should have an individual Record of Faith Journey.

MEMBERSHIP REPORT

Membership (Last Charge Conference) _____
Total Members Received _____
Total Members Removed _____
Total Membership as of _____

T – Transfer

OD – Other Denomination

PF – Profession of Faith

R – Restored

CC – Charge Conference Actions

WD – Withdrawal

WC – Withdrawal Under Charges

D – Death

PROFESSING MEMBERS RECEIVED

Name	Date	How Rec'd?
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PROFESSING MEMBERS REMOVED

Name	Date	How Removed?
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BAPTISMS (All Ages)

Name	Date	How Rec'd?
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B – Baptized

P – Professing

INACTIVE MEMBERS

3 Years
(list by name)

2 Years
(list by name)

1 Year
(list by name)

Contact Efforts

- * Letter Returned Unable to Deliver
- ** No Response
- WD** Withdrawal

Membership Secretary's Signature

Pastor's Signature

Date

Date